

Pseudoreligion

From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia
(Redirected from Pseudo-Religion)

Pseudoreligion (or pseudotheology) is a generally pejorative term applied to a non-mainstream belief system or philosophy which is functionally similar to a religious practice, typically having a founder, principal text, liturgy and faith-based beliefs. Belief systems such as Theosophy, corporate Kabbalism, Discordianism, Scientology, and Objectivism, and have all been referred to as pseudoreligions. The more serious-minded participants in these groups prefer to consider themselves part of a proper religion, however the mainstream tends to ascribe to them fringe status.

When viewed as dangerous, particular pseudoreligions may be referred to as cults. Innocuous ones—which are often satirical or parodies of traditional beliefs—such as the Church of the SubGenius, the First Presleyterian Church of Elvis, the Divine (<http://www.geocities.com/presleyterian-church/home.html>) or the Church of the Flying Spaghetti Monster, might be considered sub-cultures.

Some pseudoreligions may begin as splinters or hold-overs from traditional religions based in Apocryphal or Pseudepigraphical writings not accepted within the originating religion. Examples of this include the various sects of Gnosticism.

Professor James Carmine, chair of Carlow University's philosophy department, proposes a three-pronged test to distinguish "authentic" religions from pseudoreligions [1] (<http://www.intellectualconservative.com/article4806.html>) :

1. Any religion lacking a guiding coherent theology is a pseudo-religion.
2. Any religion entirely self referential is pseudo-religion.
3. Any religion whose only fruit is adherence to itself is pseudo-religion.

10 creepiest cults and religious practices

Varieties of pseudoreligions — with roots in science fiction

- ✱ Church of All Worlds — Based on Heinlein's "stranger in a strange land"
- ✱ Discordianism
- ✱ Gnosticism
- ✱ Corporate Kabbalism
- ✱ Lachrymology
- ✱ MOOism
- ✱ Raelism
- ✱ Randianism/Objectivism
- ✱ Scientology
- ✱ Theosophy
- ✱ Pastafarianism — flying Spaghetti monster
- ✱ Church of The Subgenius
- ✱ Tree temple of psychic youth
- ✱ Church of Euthanasia — mascot — The lemming
- ✱ ecclesia madonna —
- ✱ The
- ✱ 10 creepiest religions —
- ✱ Jediism — star wars
- ✱ The prince Phillip movement
- ✱ The athering society

See also

- New religious movements
- Parody religion
- Pseudophilosophy
- Pseudoscience
- Approaches to distinguishing religion from non-religion

Scientology

Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

Scientology is a system of beliefs, teachings, and rituals that originated as philosophy in 1952 by author L. Ron Hubbard, and characterized by the Church of Scientology in 1953 as an "applied religious philosophy". Hubbard defined the word "Scientology" to mean "a study of knowledge."

The term *Scientology* is a trademark of the Religious Technology Center, which licenses its use and use of the copyrighted works of Hubbard to the Church of Scientology. The Church presents itself as a religious non-profit organization dedicated to the development of the human spirit and providing counseling and rehabilitation programs. Church spokespeople claim that Hubbard's teachings (called "technology" or "tech" in Scientology terminology) have freed them from addictions, arthritis, depression, learning disabilities, mental illness and other problems.

However, the Church of Scientology has attracted much controversy and criticism. Critics — including government officials of certain countries — have characterized the Church as an unscrupulous commercial organization, and it is accused of harassing critics and exploiting members. Scientology's principles have been characterized as pseudoscientific by many mainstream medical and psychotherapeutic practitioners, and the Church has frequently been characterized as a cult.

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Beliefs and practices

Main article: Scientology beliefs and practices

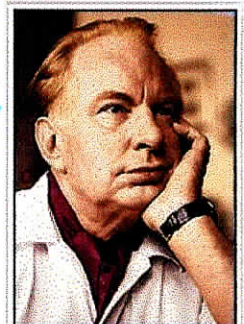
Scientology's doctrines were established by Hubbard over a period of about 34 years, beginning in 1952 and continuing until his death in January, 1986. Most of the basic principles of the church were set out during the 1950s and 1960s. Scientology followed on the heels of Dianetics, an earlier system of self-improvement techniques laid out by Hubbard in his 1950 book, *Dianetics: The Modern Science of Mental Health*. By the mid-1950s, Hubbard had relegated Dianetics to a sub-study of Scientology. A chief difference between Dianetics and Scientology is that Dianetics focuses on rehabilitating an individual's mind, giving him full conscious recall of his experiences while Scientology is more concerned with rehabilitating the human spirit. [1]

(http://www.scientology.org/en_US/religion/presentation/pg006.html) Scientology also covers topics such as ethics and morality, (The Way to Happiness), drug and chemical residues as they relate to spiritual wellbeing, the (Purification Rundown), communication, marriage, raising children, dealing with work-related problems, educational matters (study technology), and the very nature of life (The Dynamics).

Scientology practices are structured in a series of levels, because Hubbard believed that rehabilitation takes place on a step by step basis. For example, the bad effects of drugs should be addressed before other issues can be addressed. The steps lead to the more advanced strata of Scientology's more esoteric knowledge. This is described as a passage along "the Bridge to Total Freedom", or simply "the Bridge," where each step of the Bridge promises a little more personal freedom in the area specified by the Bridge's definition.

Some central beliefs of Scientology:


This article forms part of the series on Scientology
Dianetics
Engram · Reactive mind <i>Dianetics</i> : MSMH · Clear
Scientology beliefs
Thetan · Past lives Tone scale · ARC · MEST Space opera · Xenu
Practices
Auditing · E-meter Purification Rundown · Study Tech
Public groups and recruitment
ABLE · CBAA · CCHR Narconon · Criminon Volunteer Ministers · WISE
Organization
Sea Org · Church of Scientology Gold Base · Celebrity Centre Office of Special Affairs Church of Spiritual Technology Religious Technology Center
Controversy
Suppressive Person · Fair Game Operation Snow White Operation Freakout Operation Clambake Rehabilitation Project Force Scientology and the legal system Scientology versus the Internet



L. Ron Hubbard, circa 1970.

- A person is an immortal spiritual being (termed a *thetan*) who possesses a mind and a body.
 - The thetan has lived through many past lives and will continue to live beyond the death of the body.
 - A person is basically good, but becomes "aberrated" by moments of pain and unconsciousness in his life.
- What is true for you is what you have observed yourself. No beliefs should be forced as "true" on anyone. Thus, the tenets of Scientology are expected to be tested and seen to either be true, or not, by Scientology practitioners.

Scientology offers an exact methodology to help a person achieve awareness of their spiritual existence and better effectiveness in the physical world. Exact methods of spiritual counseling are taught and practiced which are designed to enable this change. According to the church, the ultimate goal is to get the soul (thetan) back to its native state of total freedom, thus gaining control over matter, energy, space, time, thoughts, form, and life. This freed state is called Operating Thetan, or OT for short.

Auditing



A Scientology recruiter introduces an E-meter to a potential convert. Such introductory audits are typically presented as "free stress tests".

The central practice of Scientology is "auditing" (from the Latin *audire*, "to listen"), which is one-on-one communication with a trained Scientology counselor or "auditor". The auditor follows an exact procedure toward rehabilitating the human spirit. Most auditing uses an E-meter, a device that measures galvanic skin response.

The auditing process is intended to help the practitioner (referred to as a preclear or PC) to unburden himself of specific traumatic incidents, prior ethical transgressions and bad decisions, which are said to collectively restrict the preclear from achieving his goals and lead to the development of a "reactive mind". The auditor asks the preclear to respond to a list of questions which are designed for specific purposes and given to the preclear in a strictly regulated way. Auditing requires that the preclear be a willing and interested participant who understands the questions, and the process goes more smoothly when he or she understands what is going on. Per Church policy, auditors are trained not to "evaluate for" their preclears; i.e., they are forbidden from suggesting, interpreting, degrading or invalidating the preclear's answers. The E-meter is used to help locate an area of concern.

Scientists have claimed benefits from auditing including improved IQ, improved memory, alleviated dyslexia and attention deficit problems, and improved relaxation; however, no scientific studies have verified these claims. Indeed, an Australian report stated that auditing involved a kind of command hypnosis that could lead to potentially damaging delusional dissociative states. Licensed psychotherapists have alleged that the Church's auditing sessions amount to mental

health treatment without a license, but the Church vehemently disputes these allegations, and claims to have established in courts of law that its practice leads to spiritual relief. So, according to the Church, the psychotherapist treats mental health and the Church treats the spiritual being.

During the auditing process, the auditor may collect personal information from the person being audited in a manner similar to a psychotherapy session or confession. The Church maintains that its auditing records are kept confidential, after the manner of confession in Christian churches. Auditing records are referred to within Scientology as "confessional formulary" and stored under lock and key when not being added to during auditing sessions. In some instances, former members have claimed the Church used information obtained in auditing sessions against them. While such a claim would be actionable as extortion, blackmail or harassment within most legal jurisdictions, no such claim has to date been legally confirmed against Scientology based upon use or revelation of auditing records.

The ARC Triangle

Another basic tenet of Scientology is that there are three interrelated (and intrinsically spiritual) components that make up successful "livingness": **affinity** (emotional responses), **reality** (an agreement on what is real) and **communication** (the exchange of ideas). Hubbard called this the "ARC Triangle". Scientists utilize ARC as a central organizing principle in their lives, primarily based upon the belief that improving one aspect of the triangle increases the level of the other two.

The tone scale

The tone scale is a characterization of human mood and behavior by various positions on a scale. The scale ranges from -40 or "Total Failure" to +40 or "Serenity of Beingness." Positions on the tone scale are usually designated by an emotion, but Hubbard also described many other things that can be indicated by the tone scale levels, such as aspects of an individual's health, sexual behavior, survival potential, or ability to deal with truth. The tone scale is used by Scientologists in everyday life to evaluate people. According to Scientology, the lower the person is on the tone scale, the more complex and convoluted his or her day-to-day problems tend to be, and the more care and judgement should be exercised regarding communication and interchange with the individual.

Past lives

In Dianetics, Hubbard proposed that the cause of "aberrations" in the human mind was an accumulation of pain and unconscious memories of traumatic incidents, some of which predated the life of the individual. He extended this view further in Scientology, declaring that thetans have existed for tens of trillions of years. During that time, Hubbard explains, they have been exposed to a vast number of traumatic incidents, and have made a great many decisions that influence their present state. According to an early lecture of Hubbard's, it is, as a practical matter, both impossible and undesirable to recall each and every such event from such vast stretches of time. As a result, Hubbard's 30-year development of Scientology focused on streamlining of the process to address only key factors. Hubbard stated that Scientology materials as described in books, tapes, and research notes include a record of everything that was found in the course of his research. Not all things found have been experienced by all beings. (For example, not everyone was a Roman, or Chinese, etc, although each was common enough)

According to Hubbard, some of the past traumas may have been deliberately inflicted in the form of "implants" used by extraterrestrial dictatorships to brainwash and control people. Scientology doctrine includes a wide variety of beliefs in extraterrestrial civilizations and alien interventions in Earthly events, collectively described by Hubbard as "space opera".

Operating Thetan levels and the Xenu incident

given religious status before RS in 1993
Germany - says it is not welcome - false
France - it is a dangerous cult

Flying Spaghetti Monster

From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

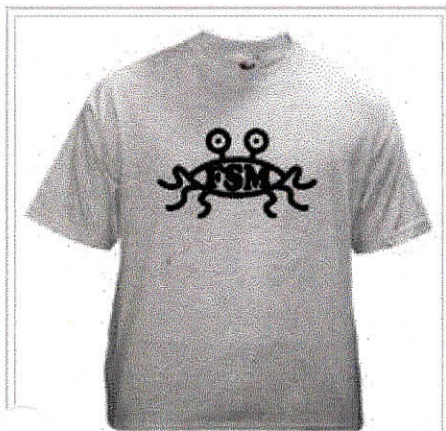
The **Flying Spaghetti Monster** is a fictional deity in a satirical religion created by Bobby Henderson in 2005 to protest the decision by the Kansas State Board of Education to require the teaching of intelligent design as an alternative to biological evolution. ~~On the site~~, Henderson professes belief in a supernatural Creator entity that resembles spaghetti and meatballs and suggests that Flying Spaghetti Monsterism should be taught in science classrooms.

The Flying Spaghetti Monster (FSM) has become the center of a phenomenon with followers who call themselves Pastafarians, a play on "Rastafarians." Although "Flying Spaghetti Monsterism" was created as a parody religion, Pastafarians say it is a legitimate one; some argue that the FSM is no more or less fictional than any other deity.

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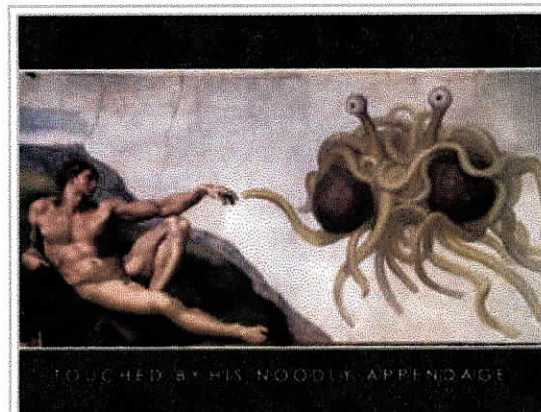
Developments



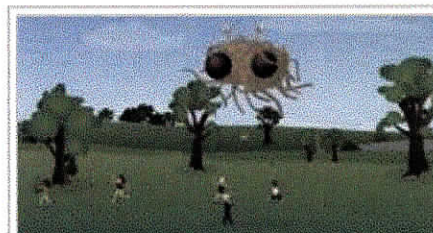
Some websites sell shirts, mugs, and other paraphernalia in support of

The site was featured on Sensible Erection on June 17, 2005 [2] (<http://sensibleerection.com/entry.php/48637>) . References on blogs and Internet humor sites such as Boing Boing, Something Awful and Fark.com soon followed.

In August 2005, in response to a challenge from a reader, BoingBoing.net (<http://www.boingboing.net/>) announced a \$250,000 challenge



The Flying Spaghetti Monster is typically depicted, as in this parody of Michelangelo's *The Creation of Adam*, as a clump of tangled spaghetti with two eyestalks, two meatballs, and many "noodly appendages".



Screenshot from the FSM church's promotional Macromedia Flash game.[1]

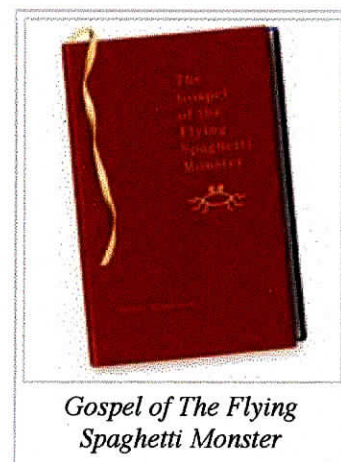
Flying Spaghetti Monsterism.

(http://www.venganza.org/games/)

~~There is a 1 million dollar challenge issued,~~
~~p://www.boingboing.net/2005/08/19/boing_boings_250000_.html~~, later raised to \$1,000,000 by other bloggers,
 payable to any individual who could produce empirical evidence proving that Jesus is not the son of the Flying
 Spaghetti Monster, though Jesus is not a part of, or worshipped in, Flying Spaghetti Monsterism. [3]
 (~~http://www.boingboing.net/2005/08/19/boing_boings_250000_.html~~) The challenge is modeled after a similar
 challenge issued by creationist Kent Hovind, which has been criticized by scientists as being logically flawed in
 design. [4] (~~http://www.talkorigins.org/indexcc/CA/CA341.html~~) The FSM prize was soon raised by matching reward
 funds to \$1 million of "Intelligently Designed currency".

The Gospel

In December 2005, Bobby Henderson received a reported USD \$80,000 advance to pen the "Gospel of The Flying Spaghetti Monster". According to the author, he plans on using the proceeds from the sale of the book to build a pirate ship, with which he may travel the world in order to convert heathens to the Pastafarian faith. [5]
 (~~http://www.boingboing.net/2005/12/22/passion_of_the_spagh.html~~) The book is due to be released on 14 March 2006 and may now be pre-ordered.



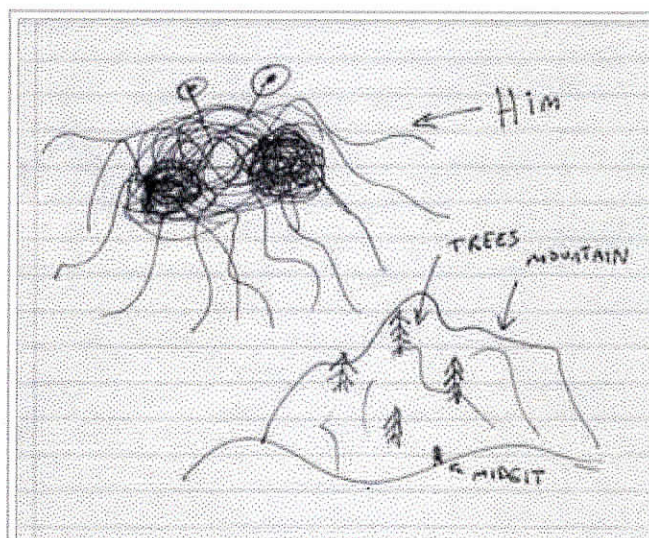
Gospel of The Flying
Spaghetti Monster

Beliefs

yayayayayayayayay i am a sailor on the coast of boliva trying to escape the dreadful count

ny of the "beliefs" proposed by Henderson were intentionally chosen to parody arguments commonly set forth by proponents of Intelligent Design. These are the canonical beliefs set forth by Henderson:

- An invisible and undetectable Flying Spaghetti Monster created the universe, starting with a mountain, trees and a "midgit" [sic].
- All evidence pointing towards evolution was intentionally planted by this being.
- Global warming, earthquakes, hurricanes, and other natural disasters are a direct consequence of the decline in numbers of pirates since the 19th Century.
- The Flying Spaghetti Monster tests Pastafarians' faith by making things look older than they really are. "For example, a scientist may perform a carbon-dating process on an artifact. He finds that approximately 75% of the Carbon-14 has decayed by electron emission to Nitrogen-14, and infers that this artifact is approximately 10,000 years old, as the half-life of Carbon-14 appears to be 5,730 years. But what our scientist does not realize is that every time he makes a measurement, the Flying Spaghetti Monster is there changing the results with His Noodly Appendage. We have numerous texts that describe in detail how this can be possible and the reasons why He does this. He is of course invisible and can pass through normal matter with ease."



A depiction of the creation of the universe with the Monster, a tree-covered mountain, and a "midgit."

Spaghetti Monster is there changing the results with His Noodly Appendage. We have numerous texts that describe in detail how this can be possible and the reasons why He does this. He is of course invisible and can pass through normal matter with ease."

Wikipedia Top 5 Church of the Flying Spaghetti monster facts

Church of Euthanasia

From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

Church of Euthanasia (also known as CoE) is a religious organization founded by Reverend Chris Korda and Pastor Kim (Robert Kimberk) in the Boston, Massachusetts area of the United States of America in 1992.^[1]

As stated in the Church's website, it is "a non-profit educational foundation devoted to restoring balance between Humans and the remaining species on Earth".^[2] Members of this organization affirm this can only turn into a reality by a massive voluntary population reduction, which will depend on a leap in Human consciousness to species-awareness.^[3] According to Rev. Chris Korda it is likely that this Church is the world's only anti-human religion.^[4]

Its most popular slogan is "Save the Planet, Kill Yourself"^[5] and its founding ideology is set in one commandment "Thou Shalt not Procreate",^[6] and four main pillars: suicide, abortion, cannibalism (of the already dead) and sodomy ("any sexual act not intended for procreation").^[2] The Church stresses population reduction by voluntary means only,^[7] therefore, murder and involuntary sterilization are strictly forbidden by church doctrine.

The Church promotes its environmental views mainly via their website (<http://churchofeuthanasia.org/>) and the web. They also utilize sermons (<http://churchofeuthanasia.org/e-sermons/e-sermons.html>), art performances, public demonstrations, culture jamming, music, publicity stunts and direct action to highlight Earth's unsustainable population. They consider their methodology similar to those of the Dadaist movement,^[8] finding the modern world so absurd that the means needed to reach their message to the public must be absurd themselves.

The Church of Euthanasia is also notorious for its conflicts with pro-life Christian activists.^[9]

Slogans employed by the group include "Save the Planet, Kill Yourself", "Six Billion Humans Can't Be Wrong", and "Eat a Queer Fetus for Jesus".^[10]

Church of Euthanasia

CoE Symbol.gif



The official symbol of the Church of Euthanasia (<http://churchofeuthanasia.org/>) is a representation of a Greek temple with four pillars

Abbreviation	CoE
Headquarters	Boston, MA. USA
Founder	Chris Korda, Robert Kimberk
Origin	1992 Registered in the state of Delaware
Official website	churchofeuthanasia.org (http://churchofeuthanasia.org/)

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- 4.1 Interviews with Chris Korda

History

The Church gained early attention in 1995 because of its affiliation with paranoia.com which hosted many sites that were controversial or skirted illegality. Members later appeared on an episode of *The Jerry Springer Show* titled "I Want to Join a Suicide Cult".^[11]

Following the September 11, 2001 attacks, the Church posted to its website a four-minute music video titled *I Like to Watch* (<http://www.churchofeuthanasia.org/catalog/video.html>), combining hardcore pornographic video with footage of the World Trade Center collapse. The montage featured an electronic soundtrack recorded by Korda and the lyrics, "People dive into the street/ While I play with my meat." (http://www.lyricsfreak.com/c/chris+korda/save+the+planet+kill+yourself_21009925.html) Korda described the project as reflecting her "contempt for and frustration with the profound ugliness of the modern industrial world."^{[12][13]}

The Church's website previously had instructions on "how to kill yourself" by asphyxiation using helium. These pages were removed in 2003 after a 52-year-old woman used them to commit suicide in St. Louis County, Missouri, resulting in legal threats against the church.^[14]

See also

- Antinatalism
- Voluntary Human Extinction Movement
- Climate Change
- Negative Population Growth
- Animal Rights
- Neo-Dada
- Absurdism
- Situationism

References

- Potts, Grant. (2005) "Church of Euthanasia". In *The Encyclopedia of Religion and Nature*, ed. by Bron Taylor, pp. 384–85. London & New York: Continuum International [1] (<http://www.religionandnature.com/ern/index.htm>).
- Paley, Nina. (2006) *Indecent Exposure*. Stay Free Magazine. [2] (<http://www.stayfreemagazine.org/archives/25/index.html>).
- Dery, Mark. (2012) "Death to All Humans! The Church of Euthanasia's Modest Proposal". In *I Must Not Think Bad Thoughts: Drive-by Essays on American Dread, American Dreams*, ed. by Mark Dery,

Soylent Green

From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

Soylent Green is a classic 1973 science fiction movie starring Charlton Heston, Edward G. Robinson and Chuck Connors. It is credited as being based on the 1966 science fiction novella about overpopulation by Harry Harrison, *Make Room! Make Room!*, but maintains only a loose structure of that work, and diverges into its own plot points and ideas.

The most common use of the term **Soylent Green** today is in reference to the fictional food product which is at the center of the film's plot.

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Movie

The movie, set in the year 2022, depicts a future dystopia, a Malthusian catastrophe that takes place because humanity has failed to pursue sustainable development and has not halted population growth. Global warming and air and water pollution have produced a year-round heatwave, food and fuel resources are scarce, housing is dilapidated and overcrowded, and widespread government-sponsored euthanasia is encouraged as a means of reducing overpopulation. Charlton Heston plays Robert Thorn, a New York City police detective, investigating the suspicious murder of William R. Simonson (Joseph Cotten), a former member of the board of the Soylent Corporation. Thorn's roommate is Sol Roth (Edward G. Robinson), a onetime college professor who is an elderly police researcher.

In the movie, meat, bread, cheese, fruit and vegetables are scarce and extremely expensive, and the government dispenses rations of synthetic food substances made by the Soylent Corporation: **Soylent Yellow**, **Soylent Red**, and the newest product, **Soylent Green**, the most popular version. As the name suggests, "Soylent" is derived from *soybeans* and *lentils*.

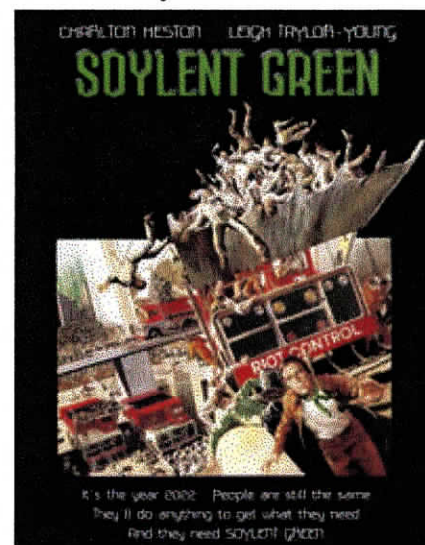
Religious institutions have become refugee centers - not functioning. However, during his investigation of the Simonson murder, Thorn uncovers a strange conspiracy, which will be revealed if he sees what goes on behind closed doors at the euthanasia centers. When an elderly and dispirited Sol opts for euthanasia, Thorn forces his way in to the euthanasia center and makes two shocking discoveries. First, he

motion pictures of the unspoiled Earth of former times, which are shown only to those about to be euthanized. Thorn is startled to see how beautiful the Earth was before it sank to its current state.

The euthanasia centers are now the functioning religious institution. promise the ultimate in beauty, peace & serenity for your last 10 minutes of life

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Soylent_Green

Soylent Green



Directed by Richard Fleischer

Produced by Walter Seltzer, Russel Thacher

Written by Harry Harrison

Starring Charlton Heston

Distributed by Metro-Goldwyn-Mayer

Released May 9, 1973

Running time 97 min

Language English

IMDb profile

(<http://www.imdb.com/title/tt0070723>)

Second, when Thorn follows the disposal of Sol's corpse, he discovers that Soylent Green includes the recycled bodies of people who have used government-sponsored euthanasia centers, as well as those killed by the Scoops, verted garbage trucks which literally "scoop" rioting citizens into large holding pens.

Thorn's anguished cry of "*Soylent Green is people!*" (one of his last lines in the movie) has become an iconic catch phrase and is frequently referenced/parodied in many other works. Reasons for this extensive use in popular entertainment are difficult to pin down to a single explanation. Some "blame" has been pointed to the film's trailer, which indirectly revealed Soylent Green's main ingredient by using quick cuts of body bags being carried across a conveyor belt over spoken narration: "What is the secret of Soylent Green?" The resulting spoiled surprise may have contributed to popular culture's tendency to refer to the movie (see Cultural impact below).

The world of *Soylent Green*

The world of *Soylent Green* is complex and detailed. It becomes clear that the culture of Earth is significantly different from the time in which it was filmed.

Lexicon

- **book** refers to people who work with books, such as researchers. Sol Roth is referred to by Thorn as a "book". Real books are rare, and no longer printed.
- **d** is the common vernacular for the currency, presumably the US dollar. Several outlandish prices are given, including 150 ds for a jar of strawberry jam and 270 ds for a few vegetables, but it is ultimately unclear if these prices are the result of the extreme famine, or inflation, as no other items' values are declared. Soylent Green costs 2 ds per kilo.
- **furniture** refers to women who are part of an organized system of concubinage, in which attractive women are offered as escorts as an amenity included with an upscale apartment.
- **scoop** refers to riot control "scoop" dump trucks which pick up rioters in mechanical grabs, as shown in the publicity picture.
- **going home** and **gone home** is a euphemism that indicates that the subject is **choosing** or has **chosen** to be euthanized.



The Scoops in action.

Trivia

- The original 1966 novella *Make Room! Make Room!* is set in the year 1999, with the theme of overpopulation and overuse of resources leading to increasing social disorder as the next millennium approaches. It mentions soylent steaks, but makes no reference to "soylent green" or to the ideas of euthanasia and cannibalism which form the basic theme of the movie. The book's title was not used for the movie since it could have confused audiences into thinking it was a big-screen version of *Make Room for Daddy*.
- This is the last movie filmed by Edward G. Robinson, who died on January 26, 1973, two weeks after he had finished filming.
- A character is briefly seen operating a *Computer Space* arcade game (an *Asteroids*-like one), marking the movie as one of the first to show the emerging pop cultural phenomenon of video games.

Cultural impact

The film has since entered into the realm of popular culture for a variety of reasons, most notably Charlton Heston's

melodramatic performance of the film's penultimate line, "Soylent Green is people!", and Phil Hartman's *Saturday Night Live* reenactment of said performance. Many television series, movies, and video games have parodied the final line of the film, especially when dealing with topics of cannibalism. Such use has become so extensive that it has become a staple of parody, used not in specific reference to the film but rather as a self-reflexive allusion to its wide use in popular entertainment. The "horrifying secret of Soylent Green", in itself, has become a popular example of a twist ending that is already known by the public at large, even those who have not seen the film (see also *Planet of the Apes* and *The Empire Strikes Back*).

External links

- *Soylent Green* (<http://www.imdb.com/title/tt0070723/>) at The Internet Movie Database
- SciFlicks.com review (http://www.sciflicks.com/soylent_green/)
- SciFlicks.com "Soylent green is people" sound clip



Wikiquote has a collection of quotations related to:
Soylent Green

(http://datacore.sciflicks.com/soylent_green/sounds/soylent_green_people.wav)

- SCIFI.com review (<http://www.scifi.com/sfw/issue55/classic.html>)

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Categories: 1973 films | Science fiction films | Dystopian films | Fictional foods | Films based on science fiction books

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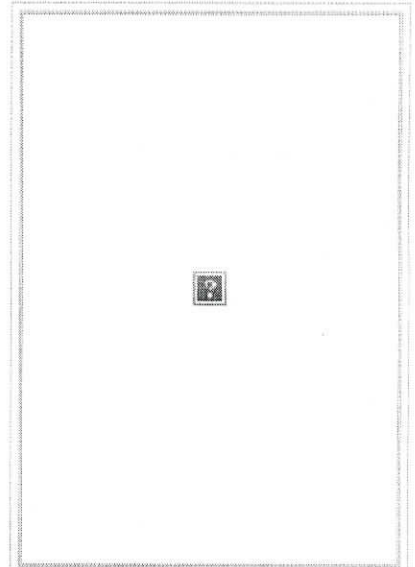
Prince Philip Movement

From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

The **Prince Philip Movement** is a religious sect followed by the Kastom people around Yaohnanen village on the southern island of Tanna in Vanuatu. It is a cargo cult of the Yaohnanen tribe,^{[1][2]} who believe that Prince Philip, Duke of Edinburgh, the consort to Queen Elizabeth II, is a divine being.

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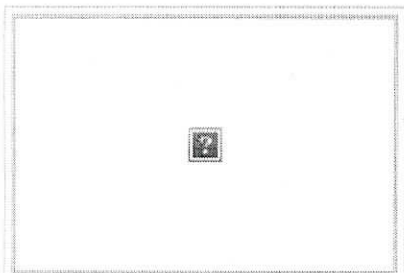
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Prince Philip in 1992, by Allan Warren.

Origins

According to ancient Yaohnanen tales, the son of a mountain spirit travelled over the seas to a distant land. There, he married a powerful woman and in time would return to them. He was sometimes said to be a brother to John Frum of another local cargo cult.



Yaohnanen tribesmen show pictures of 2007 visit with Prince Philip

The people of the Yaohnanen area believe that Prince Philip, Duke of Edinburgh, the consort to Queen Elizabeth II, is a divine being. They had seen the respect accorded to Queen Elizabeth II by the colonial officials and concluded that her husband, Prince Philip, must be the son referred to in their legends.

It is unclear just when this belief came about, but it was probably some time in the 1950s or 1960s. It was strengthened by the royal couple's official visit to Vanuatu in 1974, when a few villagers had the opportunity to actually see Prince Philip from a distance. The Prince was not then aware of the cult, but it was brought to his attention several years later by John Champion, the British Resident Commissioner in the New Hebrides.

Champion suggested that Prince Philip send them a portrait of himself. He agreed and sent a signed official photograph. The villagers responded by sending him a traditional pig-killing club called a *nal-nal*. In compliance with their request, the Prince sent a photograph of himself posing with the club. Another photograph was sent in 2000. All three photographs were kept by Chief Jack Naiva,^{[3][4]} who died in 2009.^[2]

Anne, Princess Royal, visited Tanna in October 2014.^{[5][6][7]} She is the only daughter of Queen Elizabeth II and Prince Philip. She had visited Vanuatu in 1974, but had not previously travelled to the island.^[8]

The cult in the news

On 27 September 2007, British television station Channel 4 broadcast *Meet the Natives*, a reality show about five Tanna men from the Prince Philip Movement on a visit to Britain. Their visit culminated in an off-screen audience with Philip, where gifts were exchanged, including a new photograph of the Prince.^[9]

In 2010 Australian journalist Amos Roberts visited Tanna and reported on the locals' celebration of Philip's 89th birthday, for SBS's magazine program *Dateline*.^[1]

In 2011 the people of Yaohnanen village were featured in an episode of the second series of *An Idiot Abroad* with Karl Pilkington.^[10]

In 2013, *Man Belong Mrs Queen*, a book by British writer Matthew Baylis, investigated the historical and anthropological origins of the movement and provided an account of the author's own stay on the island of Tanna.^[11]

An interview about the movement featured in a programme about Mount Yasur made by Kate Humble for BBC and broadcast in 2015.^[12]

See also

- Cargo cult

References

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10. "An Idiot Abroad 2 Episode 1: Desert Island". *Sky1 HD*.
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12. Kate Humble: Into the Volcano, BBCTV2, 8 to 9 pm, 4 January 2015



Raëlism

From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

Raëlism (also known as **Raëlianism** or the **Raëlian movement**) is a UFO religion that was founded in 1974 by Claude Vorilhon (b. 1946), now known as **Raël**. The Raëlian Movement teaches that life on Earth was scientifically created by a species of extraterrestrials, which they call the **Elohim**. Members of this species appeared human when having personal contacts with the descendants of the humans that they made. They purposefully misinformed early humanity that they were angels, cherubim, or gods. Raëlians believe that messengers, or prophets, of the Elohim include Buddha, Jesus, and others^{[2][3][4]} who informed humans of each era.^[5] The founder of Raëlism, members claim, received the final message of the Elohim and that its purpose is to inform the world about Elohim and that if humans become aware and peaceful enough, they wish to be welcomed by them.

The Raëlian Church has a quasi-clerical structure of seven levels. Joining the movement requires an official apostasy from other religions. Raëlian ethics include striving for world peace, sharing, democracy and nonviolence.^[6] Sexuality is also an important part of the Raëlian doctrine and its liberal views of sexuality have attracted some of its priests and bishops from other religions.^[7]

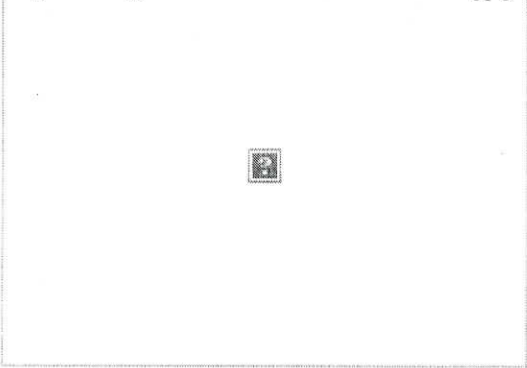
Raël founded Clonaid (originally Valiant Venture Ltd Corporation) in 1997, but then handed it over to a Raëlian bishop, Brigitte Boisselier in 2000.^[8] In 2002 the company claimed that an American woman underwent a standard cloning procedure that led to the birth of a daughter, Eve (b. 26 December 2002). Although few believe the claim, it nonetheless attracted national authorities and the mainstream media to look further into the Raëlians' cult status.

The Raëlians frequently use the swastika as a symbol of peace, which halted Raëlian requests for territory in Israel, and later Lebanon, for establishing an embassy for extraterrestrials. The religion also uses the swastika embedded on the Star of David.^[9] Starting around 1991, this symbol was often replaced by a variant star and swirl symbol as a public relations move, particularly toward Israel.

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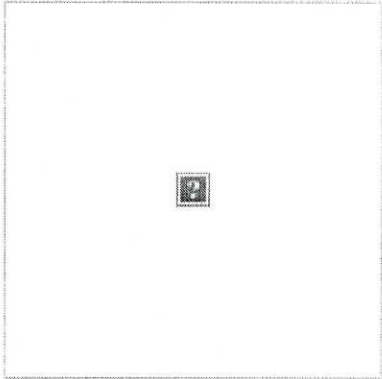
A gathering of Raëlians in South Korea.jpg



A gathering of Raëlians in South Korea.

Formation	1974
Type	New religious movement UFO religion
Headquarters	Geneva, Switzerland ^[1]
Founder	Claude Vorilhon ("Raël")
Key people	Claude Vorilhon Brigitte Boisselier
Website	rael.org (http://www.rael.org)

A series of articles on the Raëlian Movement

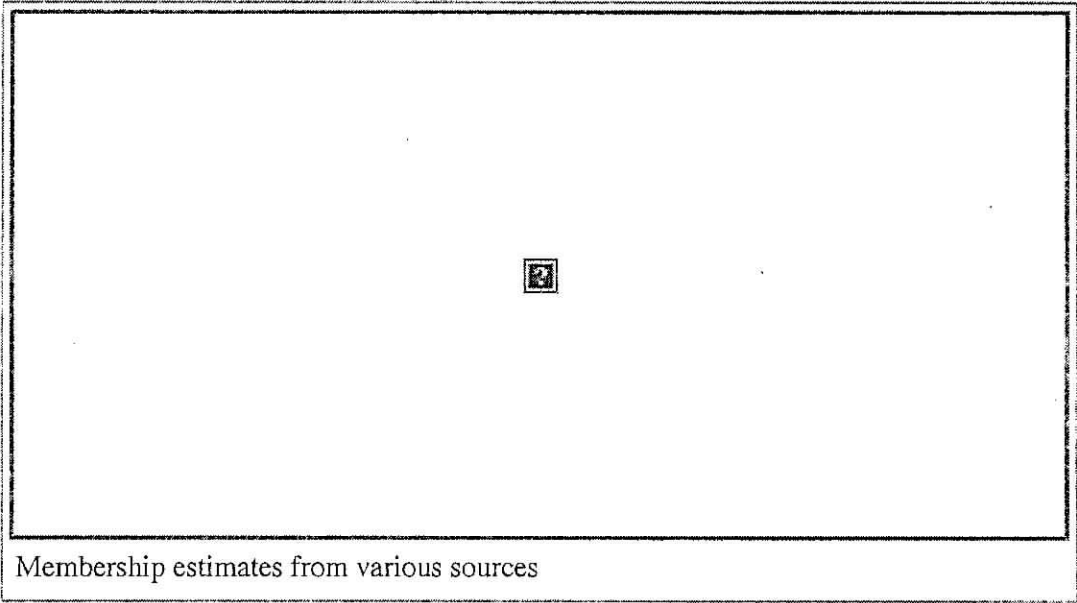


Founder • History	Views on:
Beliefs & practices	Politics
Cloning (Clonaid)	Economics
Funds	Cosmology

5.8	A form of meritocracy
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History

The beginnings of Raëlism are rooted in the claims of a French former automobile journalist and race car driver Claude Vorilhon. In his books *The Book Which Tells the Truth* (1974) and *Extraterrestrials Took Me to their Planet* (1975), Vorilhon alleges that he had alien encounters with beings who gave him knowledge of the origins of all major religions.



The movement traces its beginnings to a conference in Paris, France of two thousand people in 1974.^[10] From there, the MADECH organization was born.^[10] The name MADECH is a double acronym in the French language; it stands both for "Movement for the Welcoming of the Elohim, Creators of Humanity" (*Mouvement pour l'accueil des Elohim, créateurs de l'humanité*) and for "Moses Preceded Elijah and the Christ" (*Moïse a devancé Élie et le Christ*).^{[11]:p. 104} By 1976, Claude Vorilhon (called Raël) transformed MADECH into the International Raelian Movement.^[12]

Table of worldwide membership estimates

Date	Estimate	Scope	Reference	
1974	170	World	International Raëlian Movement	[10]
1975	700	World	Raël	[11]:p. 122

2005-11-18	60,000	92 countries	<i>Middle East Times</i>	[40]
2006-06-25	55,000	World	<i>The Daily Telegraph</i>	[41]
2006-12	65,000	86 countries	International Raëlian Movement	[10]
2011-9	85,000	90 countries	International Raëlian Movement	[42]
2013-12	90,000	90 countries	International Raëlian Movement	[42]

Table of regional membership estimates

Date	Estimate	Scope	Reference	
1995	4,000	Japan	<i>University of Virginia</i>	[22]
1995	4,000	Quebec	<i>University of Virginia</i>	[22]
1995	10,000	Europe	<i>University of Virginia</i>	[22]
1996-01-14	50	Miami	<i>The Miami Herald</i>	[18]
1996-01-14	600	United States	<i>The Miami Herald</i>	[18]
2001-08-08	24	South Florida	<i>South Florida Sun-Sentinel</i>	[43]
2002-12-31	5,000	South Korea	<i>AP Worldstream</i>	[44]
2003-02-10	6,000	Japan	<i>Japan Today</i>	[33]
2003-02-12	20 or more	Utah	<i>KSL-TV</i>	[45]
2003-04-04	1,000	United States	<i>Las Vegas Sun</i>	[46]
2003-04-20	50	Ireland	<i>Irish Independent</i>	[47]
2003-08-03	4,000	South Korea	<i>Korea Times</i>	[34]
2004-04-23	80	New Zealand	<i>New Truth & TV Extra</i>	[37]
2005-05-05	100	Southern California	<i>NBC 4</i>	[39]
2006-06-04	200	Australia	<i>The Daily Telegraph</i>	[41]

From 1980 to 1992 Raël and his movement became increasingly global. In 1980 Claude Raël's fifth Raëlian book *Sensual Meditation* was published and formal publication of the Raëlian Messages in the Japanese language began^[48] as part of the Raëlian mission to Japan.^{[16]:p. 64} Two years later, Africa became another target area in the mission to spread the Raëlian messages.^{[16]:p. 64}

On 26 December 2002, Brigitte Boisselier, a Raëlian Bishop and CEO of a biotechnology company called Clonaid, announced the birth of baby Eve, supposedly the first-ever human clone. The announcement ignited much media attention, ethical debate, doubt, criticism, and claims of a hoax. Spokespeople for the movement, including Claude Vorilhon, have suggested that this is one of the first steps in achieving a more important goal. They claim that through cloning they can combine an accelerated growth process with some form of mind transfer, and in such, may achieve eternal life.^{[49][50]}

Member hierarchy

The structure of the Raëlian Church is hierarchical, with seven levels ascending from level 0 to level 6.^[53] The top four levels consist of "Guides". The level 6 guide, known as the "Guide of Guides", has the final say on who becomes a level 5 "Bishop Guide" or a level 4 "Priest Guide".^[53] Bishops and priests promote lower-level members one level at a time during annual seminars. Each bishop or priest can propose a new guide as long as the candidate is from a level below his or her own. Guides can assist "Regional Guides"—level 3 and above^{[51][52]}—in their assigning of non-guide members to levels 3 ("Assistant Priests"), 2 ("Organizers") and 1 ("Assistant Organizers").

Members of the Raëlian structure begin as level 0 "trainees" during annual seminars. The Raelian structure claimed in 2007 to have about 2,300

members,^[54] 170 "Raëlian guides",^[55] and 41 bishops.^[56] Claude Vorilhon has held the highest position for three seven-year terms.^[53]

Women-only groups

Women make up only a third of the membership in the Raëlian Church,^{[16]:p. 117} though two anecdotes in the Raëlian Contact newsletter report female majorities joining the movement's Asian Mongolian chapter.^{[57][58]} Women such as Brigitte Boisselier, the Chief Executive Officer of Clonaid, play a powerful role in the Raëlian Church. There are two major groups of women in the Raëlian Church.

The *Order of Angels*, founded in the 1990s, consists of over a hundred Raëlian women who call for femininity and refinement for all of humanity.^{[59][60]} The initiation rites include declaring an oath or making a contract in which one agrees to become defender of the Raëlian ideology and its founder Raël.^{[61][62]} The Order of Angels has its own hierarchy of "rose angels" and "white angels" which, as of 2003, are six and 160 women, respectively.^[12] After the Clonaid human cloning claim made the headlines, the *Daily Telegraph* wrote that members of the order not only provided sexual pleasure for Raël, but also helped donate eggs for efforts towards human cloning.^[63] A few days later, *Time* magazine wrote that French chemist Brigitte Boisselier was an Order of Angels member.^[64] Around this time, cult specialist Mike Kropveld called the Order of Angels "one of the most transparent movements" he had witnessed, though he was alarmed by the women's promise to defend Raël's life with their own bodies.^[62]

Raël has instructed some women members to play a pro-sex feminist role in the Raëlian Church. "Rael's Girls" is another group of women in the movement which are against the suppression of feminine acts of pleasure, including sexual intercourse with men or women. Rael's Girls solely consists of women who work in the sex

Level 6:

Guide of Guides

Planetary guide

Level 5:

Bishop

Continental head

National guide

Regional guide

Level 4:

Priest

National guide

Regional guide

Level 3:

Assistant Priest

Regional guide

Level 2:

Organizer

Level 1:

Assistant Organizer

Level 0:

Trainee

Sources^{[51][52]}

PSUDO-RELIGION

DRAGON RIDERS OF PERN - The hatching ritual

Pern is settled toward the beginning of human expansion into space to found colonies. They become "lost", not because they are not where they are supposed to be but because of the orbital path of another planet in their system.

About 50 years after arriving, this planet passes in such a way as to cause dangerous spores to fall on Pern destroying everything that is not fire proof. This occurs every 200 years, tho occasionally it is 400. As a result, the whole colony must move to the northern continent and make their homes in caves where they will be safe, leaving all their technology behind.

One of the defenses, and the only one remembered after 2 millenia by the survivors of the colony (who had lost a significant amount of thier culture due to various plagues as well as the spores)are fire breathing dragons.

These dragons were a genetically engineered derivative of an indiginous species which already instinctively fought the spores.

The way they had been genetically engineered had been lost but the ritual which had developed around the hatching out of the new clutch of baby dragons and thier telepathic identification one on one with those humans who became their caretakers and riders has developed what can only be described as a religious ritual.

Anne McCaffrey deliberately created Pern without any vestiges of Terran religion, believing that religion would become deivisive if any were sanctioned. However, in the telling and growth of this series in meeting the human needs of the situation on Pern, what would nominally be considered religious cerimonies and roles developed.

The top of the 'heirarchy' were the Harpers. These were the teachers and preservers of tradition who were charged with making sure knowledge was not lost by writing songs or ballads about events. These harpers also served the priestly role of

marriages, burials, etc. and most importantly, the hatching ceremony of a clutch of baby dragons.

HATCHING CEREMONY (RITUAL)

This is the highest honor a person can have, to be invited to be a candidate for the hatching ritual. A search is carried out to discover those young people, usually just past puberty, who have some telepathic ability.

On the day of the hatching, candidates wear sandals and white robes. The sand on which they stand is quite warm as it has had to keep the eggs warm during gestation. This area is sacred in the sense that no one is to go there while the eggs are getting ready to hatch. Only when the day comes for hatching are people allowed in this area of the wye.

As eggs hatch, the dragonette chooses the one to whom it will telepathically bond. This instantaneous telepathic communion between human and dragon, which is a life long imprinting, is described in terms overlapping the spiritual, a higher relationship than sex or even marriage.

This whole ceremony is viewed by an audience (congregation?) sitting on tiers of bleachers who vicariously take part in the ceremony. To even be invited to attend this ceremony was considered a high honor. Following the hatching ceremony, the wye throws a huge banquet for all those attending.

In a sense, this is a matriarchy for when the queen flies her mating flight only the male who mates with her and his rider are considered as head of the wye. There is such a close bond between the dragons and their riders that when they mate, so do their riders.

The senior queen dragon has many primary responsibilities as does her rider. However, the human male leader of the wye can change if the queen dragon chooses a different mate.

Pern even has its saints.

The stories of how MOETA saved them from a plague hundreded of years before are still told as if she were a saint.

Lessa, another great wher woman, saved Pern from the spores, or thread as its called, by going back in time on her dragon and bringing forward enough weyrs from 400 years before to fight thread.

Of the harpers, Chief harper ROBINTON is revered like the pope. The cheif harpers of all eras are considered to be the highest in the heirarcy.

Thus, it is evident that even when a human society tries to avoid religion per se, the human need for heirarcy, ritual and heros or saints take over and a society will develop them. This is certainly true on Pern, even if McCaffrey didn't intend it, it happened anyway. This is a pseudo, or even secular religion.

* * * * *

This book is about a psudo religion developed by scientists after WW III to control people. It is revealed early that the year is 2305. There is a mighty Colosus of the god (Christ) outside the main temple. The "priesthood" uses scientific knowledge to fool the populous into thinking that they are supernatural.

The class system has been reinacted on Earth and God has taken a new role over the poor public. One priest, brother Jarles, has a different take on things and defects from the order to join the witches of the dark underground who worshimp Satanus. He did this because of his anger at finding out how the priesthood had invented a false religion in order to control people.

The most interesting twist is how Leiber moved away from science explaining the supernatureal to science using the supernatural to maintain control on an ignorant society of peasents. The society was deliberately designed on the medieval modle of serfs and overlords. Even the housing was the same as in the middle ages.

In the end, the oppressive brotherhood is overrun by the witches in a spectaculaar show of technological power. At the end, both the religion invented by the priesthood and the religion of witchcraft were ended and people were restored to freedom, tho it never says how this played out.

It is a fascinating and imaginative description of a world struggling with issues of political and religious freedom as well as a book about the intermingling of supernatural and technological phenomena.

* * * * *

This is one of Heinlein's early books and shows in the fact that it is somewhat simplistic for him. The science aspect is weak and has a quasi-magical feel to it. It is also true that there are cultural aspects (racism, sexism, militarism) that were part of the American mindset right after WW II and right at the onset of the cold war with the soviet union.

These aspects are now outdated but the book was published the same year that China was becoming communist, which was perceived as a huge threat to America.

The story involves the members of a top-secret military research installation that come across a new superweapon on the same day the USA (and all her allies?) capitulates to an invasion force from the "Panasians", a deliberately vague term for a supernational presumably consisting of present day China, Korea, and Mongolia.

the story involves the method of implementing the new weapon while minimising casualties among the civilian population.

the chosen method was to form a "Sixth Column" loosely based on the 5th column idea that destroyed the European democracies from within in the days before WW II. However, it would not be a fifth column of traitors but the antithesis of that, a sixth column of patriots whose job would be to destroy the morale of the invaders, by misdirection, making them unsure of themselves.

to do this, the scientists set up a new religion, constructed a temple on top of their underground facility, and began to spread out with their "priests" using scientific technology to do miracles and confound the panasians. In this way they built up recruits and organized a secret army.

This aforementioned secret weapon has the ability to pick victims by race, based on the belief of the time that different races have different blood. This has since, of course, been proven false.

The weapon s and technology did not only kill asians but could kill anyone or everyone depending on the settings. The same technology also could be used to heal, transmute, and protect.

This is one of the best Sci fi books involved in the deliberate creation of a religion in order to subvert the enemy. The reason they could do so was because the pan asians allowed worship in churches as the only way for people to gather since they beleived that this was one way to keep people submissive.

This book is definately a product of its time, but nevertheless it does not disappoint. In typical Heinlein style, he uses a completely unorthodox method to raise an army, and it is consistant sideways thinking that keeps Heinlein's books fresh and interesting after all these years.

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SOYLENT GREEN

Story Line: Near future, extreme over-population, resources nonexistent.

In the not too distant future, an over-populated world has depleted any and all available resources. "Food" is rationed and has taken the form of various colored "crackers".

The society has divided into an ultra-upper class, a middle class that more closely resembles an "upper" poverty class, and all others are lower or lesser classes.

Churches and Temples are more refugee centers than houses of worship.

Lawyers and judges are called "books" (for their knowledge) and "work" for the police.

Police are upper poverty class members.

The bodies of the dead are scooped into dump trucks for "burial" enmasse cause there isn't any room for private burial.

Compared to typical housing, the euthanasia centers are pleasure palaces and made to appear a most desirable alternative to life, especially old age.

The "books" suspect that the green crackers, which are apparently the most nutritious and life sustaining, are not the soy by-product they are claimed to be.

In an attempt to prove where the green crackers are coming from, Edward G. Robinson, Charlton Heston's book, has opted for euthanasia. He wants Heston to follow his body thru disposal processing so that the people will know how the ultra-upper ruling class has degraded them into cannibalism.

In a world that God has apparently forsaken and houses of worship are little more than refugee camps, the euthanasia centers (which are voluntary) promise those who enter the ultimate in beauty, peace and serenity for the last 10 minutes of life. Death is greeted and worshipped with all the pomp and glory of a well-directed liturgy.

eating crackers like eating meat

Tibeten Buddhism:

The BON religion is the pre Buddhist heritage of Tibet and its traditions and practices have come down to the present. the practioners of this call themselves Bon-Po.

The Bon Po believe in a King of heaven whose son became the first king of Tibet. However in the 8th cent., ce the ladder connecting heaven to earth was cut so there is no longer contact except by a few priests and magicians. This is the same cent. that Buddhism came to Tibet and much of Tibeten Buddhism contains Bon beliefs. Bon-Po is still found in more isolated northern and western areas.

The shaman is the most important figure for in trance he/she controls the gods and demons, the weather, and heals the sick. Buddhism again has taken in many of these ideas. The Dalai Lama has an oracle, a weather controller, a healer, etc.

LAMAISM is the form of Buddhism which came to Tibet in the 8th cent. CE. Salvation is found thru a Bodhisattva, one who is reincarnated over and over in order to help all creatures come to enlightenment.

A lama is one who has reached a certain advanced stage of evolution and can choose to go on to another plane of existence, or return to earth to learn something more or to help others. In Tibet, these are called "living Incarnations" and they can be traced by various means by those who knew them before death.

Lamas are usually reincarnated within 49 days of death so in three or so years, the monks will try to find the important ones by signs they left, by whether they know their possessions, etc.

THE THIRD EYE

It is believed that at one time all people had the thrid eye, which is in the center of the forehead. AT that time, the gods

walked upon the earth and mixed with humans. Humans had visions of replacing the gods and tried to kill them and as punishment, the third eye was closed. Now only certain persons could have it reopened.

the talent of using the third eye is to enable one to help others, not to enrich yourself. It is especially used by lamas involved in medical work for it enables one to see what causes sickness.

to open the third eye a U shaped shaft with teeth around the edge of the u is pressed on the area where the third eye is located and rotated till it presses thru to the bone. then a treated sliver of wood is left until the area heals, about 2 or three weeks.

When completed it enables a person to see people as they are and not as they pretend to be. Learning what each color means, and how to use it to determine the state of a persons health is a long term process. The aura a person projects varies in color, intensity, fluctuation, etc.

One can tell whether someone is telling the truth, full of hate or love, etc. Other lamas, who are holy, are surrounded by a gold aura. For ex: a thread of color vibrating above a persons heart with a certain shade and vibration indicates pulmonary disease.

The main purpose of the third eye in Tibetan Buddhism was to diagnose illness, whether spiritual or physical, and never to use for self gain. Thus only high lamas are given this operation, and then only a few.

SOUL HUNTER (Bab. 5)

a soul hunter, or Shock ^{toth} ~~toth~~ as the mimbare call them, are immortal and of unknown origin. They belong to an order, never named, who take the soul's of important people at death. Not all but rather leaders, poets, blessed lunatics, etc. Ie. those who can teach wisdom.

They use a mantra, as in Tibet and denies being a thief, but rather says he is a preserver of souls, albiet, only the special ones.

they are enshrined and apparently the soul hunters collect, talk to and listen to them.

they believe the soul ends with death unless it is cauggh and preserved.

In Tibet the Lamas are searched out a few years after they die in order to preserve the wisdom from generation to generation in this case the souls are kept to preserve their wisdom.

Evil comes in when this one soul catcher had so many failures that he becaome frustrated and began killing those whose souls he wanted to preserve. This is against the orders rules and he has to be stopped.

the third eye in these men give them the ability to see what a person is really like. as the one says: "If you could only see" and I take he means by this his ability to see what people really are by using his third eye.

note the burriel in space with a capsual. as the discussion last week about a cohen in a graveyard.

Saul Hunter - believes soul ends w/ death

mimbare - believe in re-incarnation into future generations
of mimbare;